

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

2024

Natalie died on November 8th, 2024.

In the early morning hours of Tuesday, December 4th, 2024, I was grumbling about how frustrated I was that Natalie couldn't be content to let our relationship work. But, in spite of everything, I still loved her¹⁸² anyway.

Then it occurred to me that I just assumed that she had moved on¹⁸³ already. But I had never actually tried to reach her. I know I'll probably just get the answering machine¹⁸⁴, but it doesn't hurt to try. What have I got to lose?

I issued the astral shout¹⁸⁵ and she immediately responded.

¹⁸² What does that say about me?

¹⁸³ Reincarnated

¹⁸⁴ The residual egregore left behind after reincarnation.

¹⁸⁵ "Astral shout" is a term I just invented for a thing I know of no other term to describe. It's simply meant to denote the act of shouting in the astral world as opposed to the physical one. It is in no way meant to conjure up

With her now standing in front of me, the first question out of my mouth was (yes, I spoke to her out loud), "Did you kill yourself?" She immediately stared down at her feet as if embarrassed and didn't want to answer. But I pressed her for an answer. "Of course I did. What else could I do?!"

"Yeah, I understand. All things considered, there wasn't any other move." She didn't tell me this, but the thought just popped into my head that she didn't shoot herself. She overdosed on Fentanyl because she remembered me saying that was the number one most pleasant way

memories of "magic missile" IYKYK.

to die.¹⁸⁶ She confirmed that it very likely is.¹⁸⁷

"Are you able to see things more clearly now? Are you able to reflect on your life without the fog of mental illness?"

"Yes, and I'm very sorry. At the time, it all made perfect sense. But looking back now, it's all just a crazy jumble."

"All I did was try my best to love you through the wall of madness you

¹⁸⁶ I was the first person outside of her immediate family to learn of her death. I was *oddly compelled* to perform an Internet search for her name along with the word 'obituary' (a search I had never performed before) mere hours after her obituary had been published. This obligated me to inform everyone else who loved her. Among them was her best friend, Krista, who happened to live on the other side of the world from me, so I messaged her via social media. Unlike most of the other people who either didn't offer any response at all to the news (which I think is weird and rude), Krista was happy to have a conversation. So, we discussed some gaps I had in my understanding of Natalie's backstory, to which she readily told me lies (presumably in keeping with some promise she had made to keep certain things confidential). We broke for the evening and resumed our conversation the following day. She started the conversation by chastising me for saying that Natalie's death had been a suicide. She never said what she had learned about the situation or from whom, but it stands to reason that she called Natalie's mother and was told that the cause of death was an "accidental overdose" rather than suicide. But really that was just her preferred method. It makes one wonder how many suicides are incorrectly coded this way and how much it impacts the statistics. But there's literally no way to know since the only differentiating factor is the intent of the victim. If they didn't leave a note, then any indication of their intent died with them.

¹⁸⁷ She actually confirmed that it was, but my brain immediately corrected her because she cannot know that without having previously experienced every other possible way to die and retained memory of them all, which she certainly did not.

had erected around yourself."

"I know," she said. Then she walked forward with outstretched arms. I embraced her and we hugged. I don't know if you've ever been hugged by a non-corporeal entity - I hadn't prior to this encounter - but it's ridiculously powerful. So much emotional pain and suffering was healed in a matter of seconds, I could hardly take an accounting of it.

I released the embrace and fell against the kitchen sink. It took several seconds to regain my balance and orientation.

"I visited you and you ignored me." She began to cry. "I thought you were supposed to be so sensitive to the presence of spirits. No one saw me..."

"I saw you. You were standing right beside my bed."

"Yes!"

"But I didn't realize it was you. I could sense that the presence wasn't malevolent, so I just ignored it. I wasn't expecting you. That possibility just seemed too unlikely. Sure, I knew the life trajectory you were on could only end one way, but I didn't expect it quite so soon."

"At least you know it's me now!"

I paused for a moment to just gaze at her now-smiling face and short yellow sun dress then said, "You know, in spite of everything you did to me, I never stopped loving you and I never will. I told you that you're my family and I meant it. Chosen family is forever. That means I'll always love you and there's nothing you can ever do to change that."

"I love you too!", she replied anxiously.

"Even in the afterlife, I'm skeptical that you truly understand what that word means. But you'll learn..."

* Awkward silence *

"Cute little house. I knew you'd always land on your feet."

I didn't respond.¹⁸⁸

I walked into the bedroom and laid on the bed in front of my laptop to begin documenting the interaction. She followed me into the bedroom. There was now a distinctly erotic air about her.¹⁸⁹

I don't know whether she gave these to me or if I pulled them from her, but my mind was suddenly flooded with images of her life.¹⁹⁰

¹⁸⁸ I didn't respond because I had that little house and the things in it despite the fact that she had stolen nearly everything I owned a couple of years earlier.

¹⁸⁹ Clearly there was an opportunity to have sex with her one last time. But I was, uncharacteristically, not into it. I was preoccupied with making sure that she transitioned in the best way and that she got the hell off of this planet before she ended up getting sucked into a fetus against her will. That being said, I don't know if that's really a thing or not, but I didn't want this to be the way I found out either!

¹⁹⁰ The images flashed across my mind much too quickly for my memory to retain any specific images. I just remember that they were images of her life that I hadn't seen before. Therefore, they could not have come from my memory and they were generated far too quickly and too many in number to have been generated by my imagination.

"You know it all started with your father. He fucked your life up."¹⁹¹
You never even had a fair shot at happiness."¹⁹²

She was visibly uncomfortable with this statement.

"But hey, you get to try again. This time try not to be born to a piece of shit."¹⁹³

"Definitely not in Indiana!"

"Girl, don't you dare come back to this motherfucker at all! Don't get swept up in some bullshit about 'we'll find each other'. We'll have 46 years between us... We ain't finding shit! Get your sexy ass to the Pleiades!"¹⁹⁴

¹⁹¹ Her father molested her on a weekly basis for years starting when she was just 6 years old. She denied that any such thing happened, but her mother confirmed it. It was, quite reasonably, the main reason why Natalie's parents divorced.

¹⁹² Her father's abuse left Natalie with a rather severe case of Borderline Personality Disorder. One aspect of that condition is an inability to experience the state of being love, which is, ironically, the thing a person suffering from BPD wants more than anything else.

¹⁹³ I would do well to heed my own advice in that regard.

¹⁹⁴ The Pleiades is a star cluster containing roughly 1,000 stars and situated about 450 light-years from Earth. It's important to note that this star cluster is only about 100 million years old and is therefore extremely unlikely to house any intelligent life.

But that's not the point...

The Pleiades is significant not as a spatial marker, but a symbolic one. It is used as a reference point for accessing various states of discarnate existence. Symbolically, the Pleiades represents an origin point that orients consciousness toward a liminal, pre-individuated state. Whether it's

"The Pleats?" She conjured an image of a very attractive young woman¹⁹⁵ wearing a comically-short-yet-still-pleated 'schoolgirl' skirt.

"The Pleiades, you perv. I'll find you there¹⁹⁶", I clarified.

"You promise?", she asked in a pleading tone.

"I promise. But you're already way over the normal cycle time¹⁹⁷ for reincarnation. So now that you've had a chance to set things right with me¹⁹⁸, get the fuck out of here and never look back at Monkey World.¹⁹⁹"

actually possible to reunite with someone via The Pleiades is unknown, but it's the best advice I had to offer in the moment.

¹⁹⁵ Natalie was a very sexual person and we frequently watched pornography together. When we did, schoolgirls were one of her favorite genres. So, she leveraged that to look cute by intentionally misunderstanding the word Pleiades and giving me one last shot at capitalizing on the chance for sex, which I'm still amazed that I ignored. I think she had simply hurt me too much at that point to even go there without it feeling really odd.

¹⁹⁶ This was a snap decision and I meant it in the moment. But after further reflection, I have to accept that the promise was really just for her comfort and is unlikely one that I will be able to literally keep. Maybe I can. But I know of no reliable evidence to suggest that such a reunion is actually possible or even metaphysically consistent.

¹⁹⁷ Classically, this is 3 days. How do I know? How many days are from Good Friday to Easter Sunday? Yup. That's what that's all about! Now you know. But in practice, the time can vary. However, most people reincarnate within about 2 weeks. She was over 3 weeks at the time of this conversation.

¹⁹⁸ It seems that she was holding out specifically to help me find closure. That confirms that she really does love me in spite of her difficulty in expressing it (due to mental illness).

¹⁹⁹ Earth

"Ok, daddy..."²⁰⁰

Then, with her head tilted upward, she spoke to the sky, "The Pleiades!"²⁰¹

And with that, she was gone.

I would be lying if I said that I'm not somewhat jealous of her. But alas, I still have work to complete...

. . . — . ★ . — . .

The Preceding is a True and Faithful Relation of What Passed for Many Minutes Between Severin Aequus and a Spirit whom He Adores.

²⁰⁰ This was significant because she liked to roleplay as "daddy" and "little girl", as disturbing as that is, especially considering the facts of her childhood. I was able to go along with it by always imagining her to be a legal-aged young woman and refused to create a mental association with her actual childhood. But during the last week we were together I noted that she stopped calling me "daddy" as she had for the 3.5 years prior. She stated that it didn't feel right to call me that because she no longer respected me. That was deeply hurtful to hear since I had done nothing to warrant losing her respect. Now, with the fog of mental illness lifted, she was trying to heal that wound.

²⁰¹ Since I'm unable to footnote a footnote (I know, right?!), here are the sources for my cosmological interpretation of The Pleiades:

1. "The Secret Doctrine" by Helena Blavatsky
2. "A Study in Consciousness" by Annie Besant
3. "The Astral Plane" by C.W. Leadbeater

But it should be noted that I treat none of the above as necessarily authoritative nor conclusive.